

YUXUAN DU

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RESEARCH PROFILE

Interests: Human-AI Interaction; AI-mediated judgment and decision-making; human-AI collaboration; LLM evaluation and auditing.
Focus: How generative AI shapes human judgment through the information and support it provides across decision processes.

EDUCATION

Hong Kong University of Science and Technology

Doctoral study in Project Management

GPA: 3.85/4.00; Hong Kong Postgraduate Scholarship recipient. Study discontinued following changes in program's funding arrangement.

Hong Kong SAR

Sep 2025 – Jan 2026

Southeast University

Master in Management Science and Engineering

GPA: 3.90/4.00; Second-Class Scholarship.

Nanjing, China

Sep 2022 – Jun 2025

Central South University

B.Eng. in Mining Engineering; B.A. in English (minor degree)

GPA: 89.47/100 (ranked 2/89); National Scholarship; Excellent Student Model; First-Class Scholarship.

Changsha, China

Sep 2018 – Jun 2022

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Remote research assistant | Prof. Zhuoran Lu (*incoming faculty, HAI Lab, University of Hong Kong*)

Jun 2026 – present

- Conducting Human-AI Interaction research on how generative AI shapes information judgment, evidence use, and decision-making.
- Contributing to research design, experimental development, data analysis, and manuscript preparation across ongoing projects.

External collaborator | Prof. Arpit Narechania, *DataVisards Lab, Hong Kong University of Science and Technology*

Jan 2026 – present

- Studied how readers combine multiple tools when verifying claims in AI-assisted sensemaking.
- Contributed to user-study design, mixed-methods analysis, system iteration, and manuscript drafting.

Graduate researcher | Prof. Xiaopeng Deng, *Belt and Road Joint Lab, Southeast University*

Sep 2022 – Jun 2025

- Led mixed-methods research on digital leadership, risk perception, and cross-cultural project management, integrating interviews, surveys, qualitative & quantitative analysis.
- Designed evaluation frameworks and scoring rubrics, developed and validated measurement scales, and conducted thematic analysis of policy documents to support organizational diagnosis and strategic recommendations.

SELECTED RESEARCH OUTPUTS

From Citations to Evidence: Citation Provenance in Citation-supported AI Answers

Under review; First author

- Audited answers from three web-enabled AI systems to trace citations to underlying evidence and characterize the prevalence, forms, and disclosure of citation dependence.
- Designed and conducted a randomized user experiment examining how citation-dependence disclosure shapes users' judgments.

Fact-check Your Information (FYI): A Design Probe to Understand How People Actually Fact-check Data-Driven Articles

IEEE TVCG, in press; IEEE VIS 2026; Co-first author

- Investigated how people fact-check data claims and calibrate trust across multiple tools through remote user studies. [Project page](#).
- Developed FYI, an interactive fact-checking probe integrating AI chat, visualization, automated checks, and table inspection.
- Led user-study design and execution, mixed-methods analysis, and manuscript development, and contributed to system iteration.

Who Chooses How Preferences Are Aggregated? Auditing Aggregation-Rule Authority in LLM-Based Group Recommendation

Under review; First author. [arXiv:2608.23966](#)

- Examined how LLMs make group recommendations when authority over preference aggregation is unspecified, retained by users, or delegated to the model.
- Designed controlled cross-model experiments separating the ability to execute an aggregation rule from the authority to select how multiple users' preferences are aggregated.
- Led the conceptualization, experimental design, LLM evaluation pipeline development, statistical analysis, and manuscript preparation.

What Personalized Agents Make Visible: A Diagnostic Framework for AI-Mediated Judgment

UbiComp/ISWC 2026 Reality Mediation Workshop, accepted and forthcoming; First author.

- Framed personalized AI decision support as an AI-mediated judgment problem, examining how agents shape the path from evidence to recommendation.
- Proposed a diagnostic framework and illustrative probe for evaluating how personalization affects evidence visibility and shared ground across users.

ONGOING RESEARCH

Grounded LLM Verification and Evaluation

Manuscript in preparation

- Developing a matched evaluation framework to separate how evidence access, source-use rules, and citation enforcement shape LLM verification outcomes.

Scope Fidelity in LLM-Assisted Refinement

Work in progress

- Examining whether LLMs preserve the intended scope of user-requested revisions, distinguishing requested changes and necessary propagation from broader substantive changes that users did not authorize.

HelpfulWidgets: AI-Enhanced Interface Widgets

Early-stage project

- Exploring how generative AI can adapt or re-express existing interface widgets around users’ immediate needs while keeping the enhancement local to the original interface and its underlying functionality.

EARLIER RESEARCH OUTPUTS

Project-Driven Digital Leadership: A Sociotechnical Conceptualization and Formation Mechanism

International Journal of Project Management (SSCI Q1), under review; First author

- Combined AI-assisted Grounded Theory coding and structural equation modeling to explain digital leadership formation in project-driven organizations from a sociotechnical perspective.
- Led the mixed-methods design, interviews and survey development, theoretical modeling, data analysis, and manuscript preparation.

Impact of Cognitive Biases on Environmental Compliance Risk Perceptions in International Construction Projects

Frontiers in Psychology (SSCI Q2), published Nov. 2024; Corresponding author; <https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2024.1397306>

- Examined how cognitive biases shape environmental-compliance risk perceptions in international construction projects.
- Presented at the 2nd International Conference on Neuromanagement in Engineering (Jun.2024, Changsha).

Cross-cultural Leadership of International Project Managers

Teaching case, China Professional-Degree Case Center, accepted Jun. 2024; Student first author

- Developed a teaching case examining leadership formation and cross-cultural management among international project managers.
- Selected as an Excellent Case in the 1st National Master of Engineering Management Teaching Case Competition in China.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

International Engineering Localization Management Standard

Jun 2024 – Feb 2025

- Served as a core drafter for a standard developed under the China Association for Engineering Construction Standardization (CECS).
- Analyzed cross-country legal, cultural, and market-entry constraints and translated the findings into standardized management guidelines.

China Construction 2035: High-Quality Development Strategy

Aug 2023 – Sep 2024

- A key consulting project for Chinese Academy of Engineering.
- Synthesized policy, engineering-management, and organizational research to inform industry priorities, strategic goals, and suggestions.

Overseas Project Management

Jul 2024 – Aug 2024

- Project management intern in Overseas Service Department, CATL Co., Ltd.
- Coordinated cross-functional teams on Ford- and Tesla-related overseas service projects, helping resolve 5+ delivery and after-sales issues.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant, Project Management of International Engineering, Southeast University

Mar 2023 – Jun 2023

Supported case-based teaching, graded assignments, coordinated classroom activities, and provided feedback to students.

Teaching Assistant, Graduate Academic English, Southeast University

Sep 2022 – Jun 2024

Provided one-to-one assignment feedback and Q&A support and organized 24 tutoring sessions per semester.

SELECTED AWARDS

2023: Grand Prize, National English Competition for College Students (Graduate Group)

2022: Second-Class Scholarship, Southeast University

2021: Excellent Student Model, Central South University

2020: National Scholarship, Ministry of Education of China (granted to the top 2% of students at the university)

SKILLS AND LANGUAGES

Methods: User studies; semi-structured interviews; thematic analysis; grounded-theory coding; survey design; structural equation modeling; mixed-methods and experimental research.

AI/HCI: LLM evaluation and auditing; Human–AI interaction study design; interactive prototyping; experimental system development.

Tools: Python; Streamlit, HTML/CSS; Tableau; Mplus; MaxQDA.

Languages: Mandarin Chinese (native); English (IELTS 8.0; CET-6 600); Korean (TOPIK Level 5).